

The Tantra Called 'The Noble Blue-Clad Vajrapāṇi Taming the Three Fierce Ones'

Ārya-Nīlāmbara-dhara-Vajrapāṇi-Rudra-vitri-vinata-tantra-nāma · Toh 454 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ལག་ན་རྩོུགས་སྒྲོ་པ་ཅན་དག་པ་གསུ་

Toh 454 in the Kangyur is a tantra known in English as "The Noble Blue-Clad Vajrapāṇi Taming the Three Fierce Ones," corresponding to the Sanskrit Ārya-Nīlāmbara-dhara-Vajrapāṇi-Rudra-vitri-vinata-tantra and the Tibetan Phakpa Lakna Dorjé Gö Ngönpo Chen Drakpo Sum. It belongs to the tantric section of the Kangyur and concerns the wrathful bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi in his blue-clad form, who is empowered by countless buddhas to subdue three fierce or wrathful beings. The text opens in a classic sūtra-like frame, with the Buddha residing in the celestial Akaniṣṭha palace of Other-Wielding Emanations, from which he commissions Vajrapāṇi as the great commander of the yakṣas to take up and transmit this teaching. As a tantra centered on a powerful, wrathful emanation of Vajrapāṇi, it reflects the broader tradition of deity-focused tantric literature concerned with protection, subjugation, and the esoteric transmission of buddha-authorized teachings.

In the language of India:
Ārya-Nīlāmbara-dhara-Vajrapāṇi-Rudra-vitri-vinata-tantra-nāma. In the
language of Tibet: The Tantra Called "The Noble Blue-Clad Vajrapāṇi Taming
the Three Fierce Ones."

Homage to the Blessed One, the Gentle Thunderbolt (Mañjuśrī).

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One, Destroyer of Māra (Skt. māravijit), together with the hosts of māra, was dwelling at ease in the palace of Other-Wielding Emanations in Akaniṣṭha.

The Blessed One declared: "Let Vajrapāṇi, the great commander of the yakṣas, the Blue-Clad One, take up this teaching, which has been authorized by buddhas as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā."

Thereupon, the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi offered this praise, saying, "I request you to speak." He praised as follows:

Homage to you who are surrounded by assemblies of countless tens of millions of billions of yakṣas; who grind and gnash your fangs in ferocity; whose eyes are like masses of firebrands; whose breath blazes forth like tongues of flame; whose voice resounds with terror; whose arms and shoulders are adorned with

lotus flowers and water deities; whose head is crowned by the wealth-bestower and the conch-bearer; who wear a blazing crown of precious serpents; who are adorned with ear-ornaments of the blazing nāgas Nandaka and Upanandaka; whose feet crush and devour blazing venomous serpents; who are girdled with Vāsuki, king of the nāgas, as a belt; who bear a black serpent as a topknot; whose full face shows brows drawn together in a frown; whose upper lip presses down; whose tongue flickers like lightning; who bear the likeness of the Lord of Death; whose great belly devours serpents; who stand so vast that the fathomless depths of the ocean — eighty-four thousand leagues — reach only to your knees; who are enthroned above the senses and the sun; who strike terror with the sound of your clapping hands; who cause trembling with the cry "A-la-la!"; who destroy all nāgas; who set everything in turmoil with great laughter; who, bearing the form of the Lord of Death, terrify the three realms; and who tame all nāgas — to you I bow.

Then, in that very sky, a great fierce one possessed of a vast palace and the meditative absorption of the great wheel gathered the retinue, and proclaimed:

Vajrapāṇi the supremely fierce,
the vajra wrathful one who vanquishes the greatly fierce,
the vajra splendor, lord of mantra,
the invincible vajra, greatly terrifying,
the vajra whose activities accomplish all purposes —
in the body of the great wheel of skillful taming,
the great self-nature of the five elements,
beautiful, radiant with rays of light,
lustrous, sending forth melodious sound and breath,
generating and accomplishing all actions —
he hooks, gathers, binds, and pacifies;
accomplishing actions that subdue the extremes,
of the indestructible nature of the bindus,
through the union, the flow and convergence of sun and moon,
the destroyer of thousands of classes of obstructors —
to you, Lord of the Wheel, I offer praise!

Through the blazing of the seed-syllable,
he nurtures and sustains skillful means and wisdom with fire;
having bestowed the drink of great bliss,
he destroys suffering and afflictions — to him I bow.

Oṃ a-kāro mukhaṃ sarva-dharmāṇaṃ ādyānutpannatvāt oṃ āḥ hūṃ.

Having thus praised the deities of the maṇḍala, the Blessed One smiled.

He said "Excellent!" to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, and dismissed the assembly.

Then Vajrapāṇi said to the Blessed One: "Excellent! Excellent! Therefore, I request you to speak this tantra — which accomplishes all things through its secret mantra, destroys all sins, and tames the three fierce ones." Having circumambulated, he sat together with the assembly in the presence of the Blessed One.

Then the Buddha, the Blessed One, declared: "For the purpose of taming the malevolent ones, this vidyā-mantra, spoken and blessed by buddhas as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā, is to be recited. It is as follows:

Tadyathā — bho bho pānnāga adhipataye, idaṃ nīlāmbara-dhara-śarīram."

Vajrapāṇi hṛdayam. Yasmāti. Kramath. Utsādanam bhaviṣyati. Tadyathā — buddha buddha vibhuddha vibhuddha, matiprapāta, hara hara nāgānām, prahara prahara sarvanāgānām, cchinda cchinda nāgaḥṛdayāni, bhindha bhindha nāgamarmāṇi, viśīryantu nāgaśarīram, visphoṭaya nāganayanāni. Tadyathā — hūṃ phaṭ. Nāgavidāraṇāya phaṭ. Nāgotsādanāya phaṭ. Nīlāvasanāya phaṭ. Apratihatavalaprakramāya phaṭ. Kṛtāntāya phaṭ. Kṛtāntarūpāya phaṭ. Roṣaṇāya phaṭ. Trāsanāya phaṭ. Kuṣmāṇḍotsādanāya phaṭ. Pretapiśācavināśakarāya phaṭ. Yakṣāpasmāravināśakarāya phaṭ. Hasa hasa. Dhara dhara. Māraya māraya. Nāśaya nāśaya. Sarvavighnāvināśakarāya phaṭ. Sarvaśatrūnsaṃghavināśakarāya phaṭ. Nīlāambaradhara-Vajrapāṇi-rājñāpayati svāhā.

At that time, for one seized by the possession of a yakṣa, the mantra is to be cast over water and the water then sprinkled. To turn back nāgas, one should use a whip of smag-shad wood or a whip of Nepalese cane. For hungry ghosts and those afflicted with forgetfulness, one should use a cord. To eliminate epidemic disease, for hemiplegia, and for those bitten by leeches, one should use a blue cord. For one who desires wealth, one should remain in fasting abstinence for a single day and be fumigated with incense, and in a dream all matters of virtue and non-virtue will be revealed. In the presence of a stūpa enshrining bodily relics, having worshipped with blue flowers and the like and recited the mantra one thousand times, one should make supplication, and it will bestow seven thousand gold coins. For one who wishes to break a seal,

one should use ashes. For one who wishes to open an iron door, one should use mustard seeds. To guard against all fears, one should use old butter, ashes, and mustard seeds. Against all fears of illness, tie a protective knot on a blue cord and wear it around the neck, and it will become the supreme protection. For children threatened by all manner of spirit possession, tie a cord of five colors around the neck and it will become the supreme protection. To drive away thieves, one should use salt. For poison, one should apply kuśa grass. To protect oneself, one should recite it mentally or with water. To protect others, one should use a blue cord. For all these activities, the mantra is to be recited — whether once, or three times, or fourteen times, or twenty-one times, or one hundred and eight times — and it will be accomplished.

When the Blessed One had thus spoken, the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, together with the host of māras, rejoiced and praised the teaching.

The noble tantra called Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garment Taming the Three Fierce Ones is complete.

The Nepalese paṇḍita Devapuṇya —

Translator's Notes

- The title's Sanskrit as given in the Tibetan transliteration is Ārya-Nīlāmbara-dhara-Vajrapāṇi-Rudra-vitri-vinata-tantra-nāma; "vitri-vinata" is an unusual compound that may represent a corrupt or dialectal Sanskrit form. The Tibetan equivalent "drag po gsum 'dul ba" means "taming the three fierce ones," suggesting the Sanskrit should convey something like tri-vibhīṣaṇa-damana or similar, but the transmitted Sanskrit title does not clearly match this.

The homage "to the Blessed One, the Gentle Thunderbolt" renders Mañjuvajra, a form combining Mañjuśrī and Vajra, or alternatively an epithet meaning the Blessed One Mañjuśrī; the Tibetan reads Bcom ldan 'das 'Jam pa'i rdo rje, which is a standard honorific of Mañjuvajra or Mañjuśrī.

The phrase rendered "nurtures and sustains skillful means and wisdom with fire" is doctrinally unusual; the Tibetan "thabs dang shes rab sreg gso mdzad" literally means "burns and heals skillful means and wisdom," which in tantric context likely refers to the fire-offering (homa) that both burns away obscurations and nourishes realization.

- The text closes mid-sentence with "The Nepalese paṇḍita Devapuṇya," which is the beginning of the colophon naming the translator or scribe; the passage breaks off before the colophon is complete.

The term rendered "smag-shad wood" is a specific Tibetan plant name that has not been definitively identified in the botanical literature; it is left transliterated rather than speculatively rendered.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.